



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Italy. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's great that you've finished primary school – congratulations! Since you're 16, you're at an important crossroads in your education. In Denmark, you have a few main educational paths to consider after primary school (Folkeskole), and your choice depends on your interests, goals, and how you like to learn.

Here's a breakdown of your main options, along with my recommendations based on your situation:

1. Gymnasium (STX) – General Upper Secondary Education

Best for: Students who want to go to university later.

- Focuses on academic subjects like Danish, English, mathematics, science, and social studies.
- Takes **3 years**.
- Prepares you well for a **broad range of university programs**.
- Great if you're still exploring your interests or want to keep your options open.

● **Recommended if:** You like school and learning from books, enjoy subjects like languages, science, or humanities, and might want to go to university someday.

2. HHX – Higher Commercial Examination Programme

Best for: Those interested in **business, economics, or international trade**.

- More focus on business, marketing, and economics.
- Also takes **3 years**.
- Often leads to university studies in business or similar fields, or to starting a career in the private sector.

● **Recommended if:** You're interested in business, possibly international business (especially with your Italian background), and practical economics.

3. HTX – Higher Technical Examination Programme

Best for: Students interested in **technology, science, or engineering**.

- Includes subjects like chemistry, physics, IT, and math.
- Also takes **3 years**.

- Ideal if you want to study science, IT, or engineering later.

● **Recommended if:** You enjoy problem-solving, science, or technical subjects.

4. EUD – Vocational Education and Training

Best for: Students who want to **learn a trade or start working earlier**.

- Combines school with **apprenticeship/workplace training**.
- Shorter (2–4 years depending on program).
- Leads to jobs like electrician, carpenter, chef, hairdresser, etc.

● **Recommended if:** You prefer hands-on work, want to start a career sooner, or already know what trade you're interested in.

5. Creative or Specialized Programs (e.g. Design, Art, Music)

- Available in some areas or as part of other education (e.g. MGK for music).
 - Good if you have a strong passion in a specific creative field.
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Bonus: International Opportunities

Since your parents are Italian, you may also be eligible for educational opportunities or exchange programs in Italy or other EU countries. Knowing multiple languages (Danish, Italian, English) is a big advantage.

How to Decide?

Ask yourself:

- Do I want to go to university? → STX/HHX/HTX
 - Do I enjoy academic work? Or do I prefer hands-on learning?
 - What subjects or careers interest me?
 - Do I want to work sooner or keep studying?
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My Personal Suggestion (based on what you've shared):

If you're not 100% sure yet and want to keep your options open, **STX** is usually the safest and broadest path. It gives you time to figure out what you like while preparing you for almost any future university education.

But if you already lean toward business, then **HHX** could be a great fit – especially if you're interested in using your multicultural background in international careers.

Would you like help comparing specific schools or programs in your area? Or are you curious about how your Italian background could help in your career later on?